

THE TEMPEST-I (WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE)

Thinking about the Text:

1. Who was Ariel and how did he come to be Prospero's servant?

Ariel was a spirit. A witch named Sycorax who lived on the island before Prospero, had imprisoned him in the heart of a pine tree. Unfortunately, Sycorax died before releasing him and therefore he remained imprisoned in the tree. It was only when Prospero landed on the island and discovered Ariel's plight, finally freed him with the help of his magical powers. Since then, Ariel became his faithful servant.

2. Who was Caliban? What did he look like?

Caliban was the ugly son of the witch, Sycorax. His appearance was more like a fish than a man.

3. What did Miranda ask Prospero to do when she saw the ship caught in the tempest?

Miranda on seeing the ship caught in the fierce storm had an inkling that it was the work of her father. So, she requested him to put an end to it as she could not tolerate the helpless cries of the sailors who were drowning in the sea.

4. What did Prospero say he raised the Tempest for?

Prospero confessed to Miranda that he had caused the storm. He said that he had done it for the sake of Miranda. However, he does not explain as to how she was going to benefit from it.

5. Why did Prospero leave the management of state affairs to Antonio?

Prospero's chief desire in life was not power, position, wealth or any other worldly possession. All that he wanted to acquire was knowledge. It was for this reason that without doubting his brother, Antonio, he left the management of the dukedom entirely to him.

6. Who helped Antonio to seize the throne?

Antonio not only bribed the ministers and won them over but also extended the hand of friendship to the King of Naples who was Prospero's chief enemy. It was with their help that he ultimately seized the throne.

7. What did Antonio's soldiers do?

One dark night, the soldiers dragged Prospero with his baby daughter, Miranda, in his hands, out of his palace. Baby Miranda was crying but they had no mercy. The soldiers then put them in an old and damaged ship believing that they would sooner or later drown and die at sea.

8. How did old Gonzalo help Prospero?

Gonzalo, a kind and faithful old Lord, helped Prospero by secretly storing the ship with food, water and clothes. He had also loaded the ship with books which were more valuable to Prospero than his entire dukedom.

9. Who were in the ship that was caught in the Tempest?

Prospero, his brother, Antonio, the King of Naples, his son Ferdinand and others were in the ship that was caught in the tempest.

10. What did Ariel remind Prospero of when Prospero mentioned more work?

Ariel reminded Prospero of his promise to set him free after he completed the tasks that had been assigned to him.

THE TEMPEST-II (WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE)

Thinking about the Text:

1. What did Miranda think at first Ferdinand was and why? Was Ferdinand and Miranda's love a love at first sight?

Miranda instantly felt that he was a spirit as he had immensely noble and beautiful looks and appeared extremely handsome. This was only natural as Miranda had never seen a young man before, with the exception of her father and Caliban.

Yes, the love between Ferdinand and Miranda was indeed a love at first sight.

2. Why did Prospero pretend to think that Ferdinand was a spy?

Prospero pretended to think that Ferdinand was a spy because he wanted to test whether he genuinely loved Miranda and even went on to imprison him in order to make it look authentic.

3. What was the task that Prospero had given to Ferdinand?

The task that Prospero gave Ferdinand to do was to pile up heavy logs.

4. What made Ferdinand's labor seem light?

Since Ferdinand was deeply in love with Miranda, her sheer presence made his labour seem light.

5. What were the King and his party doing in the meantime?

The King and his party were lost, wandering around on the island. They got tired and hungry and sat down to rest.

6. Why were they amazed to see Prospero?

They were extremely amazed to see Prospero because they believed him to have been drowned in the sea years ago.

7. Prospero told the king that he had lost his daughter in the tempest and in a sense he was right. Can you say in what sense?

What Prospero meant when he told the King that he had lost his daughter in the tempest was that she had become a victim of the tempest of love. She had fallen in love with Ferdinand.

8. Why did Prospero give up his magic powers?

Prospero gave up his magic powers because he had achieved what he desired from life and had no further use of them.

9. What was Ariel's last service to his master?

Ariel's last service to his master was to help him them with favourable winds as Ferdinand, Miranda, the King, Antonio and the others set sail for Naples.